

Fittings

Going through all the fittings involved in an open loop liquid cooling system can be overwhelming. There can be hundreds of different fittings available based on the configuration one is planning. To keep it simple, we will be covering the basics that you need to keep in mind while planning your loop. Fittings are the parts used to fit the tube with the reservoir and water blocks. Sometimes, fittings are also used to connect hard tubes with each other, that can't be bent, with angle joints. They are made such that they prevent any leakage at the joint. The primary type of fittings are barbed or compression fittings. Barbed fittings have a smaller diameter lip so that the tube can easily enter. These are generally used with soft tubing and you will find more than one barbed ring in them. Compression fittings are barb fittings with threading at the bottom for a lock ring to ensure a tighter fit.



You need to ensure you get the right ID and OD measurements on compression fittings

You will generally find compression fittings used on hard tubing. However, compression fittings can also be used for soft tubing as well. Compression fittings are more expensive but they prevent the tubes from being pulled out, and they also look aesthetically more pleasing. Barb fittings have a low price but you will have to additionally buy hose clamps. There are also push-in fittings for hard tubes where you literally push in the hard tube into the fitting. There are two washers or o-rings inside for an airtight seal. Finally, the most important aspect you need to keep considering are the ID and OD measurements. All you need to do is match them with the tube and you won't have any problems.